as best we could, but we never borrowed money from anyone, not from our parents, nor withdrew any money from the PF. I remember one month that was particularly critical, we were almost broke when a cheque arrived in the mail for a short story that I had written for the *Infantry Journal* a few months earlier. That cheque for Rs 300 was like a blessing from heaven and pulled us through to the end of the month.

I must have done well in the course because, on its termination, I was posted as the Brigade Major (BM) of 28 Infantry Brigade at Sunderbani, J & K which was part of 10 Infantry Division. I had been to Sunderbani a few times during my the earlier tenure at Budhwal as part of the same Division. It was again a field posting, so I once again applied for SF accommodation in Pune. Pune is a high-pressure station as far as accommodation is concerned, and I had to run from pillar to post to get the SF accommodation allotted in the two months annual leave that I had been granted before joining the new assignment. This time we were allotted a house at Gurudwara Road, closer to the city, and within walking distance of Pune's famous Main Street (though renamed Mahatma Gandhi [MG] Road, it is still known as Main Street only). Isha was admitted to St Mira's Girls School on Sadhu Vaswani Road and Amala into the playschool of St Mary's Girls School, where Veena had taught earlier. Unlike on the previous occasion when I had moved to Sri Lanka, at least this time I could settle Veena and the girls before moving out. Later on, Veena would get a part-time job at the St Mira's College for Girls. While at Wellington, Veena had learnt to drive the car, so even in my absence, she could take the girls out to my parents' place or for other short outings. Veena made sure she was not dependent on me and I think that it is important for all our Army wives to be so, given the inherent risk in our profession. In fact, I would

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